

Exhibit V: Committee Code of Ethics

Companion document to the BCOC Bylaws 2026 Amendment Package

Status: Already adopted in 2025 · **Action requested:** Acknowledgment only (no vote)

Members are asked to acknowledge they have received and reviewed this Code of Ethics, which is incorporated by reference into Article XII, Section 5 of the BCOC Bylaws.

Committee Code of Ethics

The Black Chief Officers Committee (BCOC) primarily represents current and aspiring Black executives in the all-hazards response community. Trust is a staple of our organization. To preserve the continuing integrity of the BCOC, the highest standards of ethical conduct shall be always maintained.

The purpose of this Professional Code of Ethics is to establish standards that encourage members to promote a culture of ethical integrity and high professionalism in our field. This Code is intended to reduce and prevent situations that could result in embarrassment, diminished credibility, or loss of support for an organization that has historically been highly respected.

All members of the BCOC share a responsibility to project professionalism, integrity, compassion, loyalty, and honesty in all that they do.

Members Shall

- Always conduct themselves, on and off duty, in a manner that reflects positively on themselves, their families, and the BCOC.
- Accept responsibility for their actions and for the consequences of those actions.
- Support fairness and the value of diverse thoughts and opinions.
- Avoid situations that would adversely affect the credibility or public perception of the BCOC.
- Be truthful and honest at all times and report instances of cheating or other dishonest or unethical conduct that compromise the integrity of the BCOC.
- Conduct personal affairs in a manner that does not improperly influence the performance of their duties or bring discredit to the BCOC.
- Be respectful and mindful of each member's safety and welfare.
- Recognize that they serve in positions of public trust that require stewardship in the honest and efficient use of human resources, fiscal resources, and all publicly owned or entrusted resources, and ensure such resources are protected from misuse and theft.
- Exercise professionalism, competence, respect, and loyalty in the performance of their duties and use information, confidential or otherwise, gained by virtue of their positions only to benefit those they are entrusted to serve.
- Avoid financial investments, outside employment, outside business interests, or activities that

conflict with, are enhanced by, or appear to be influenced by their official positions.

- Never propose or accept personal rewards, special privileges, benefits, advancement, honors, or gifts that may create a conflict of interest, or the appearance of a conflict of interest.
- Never discriminate on the basis of race, religion, color, creed, age, marital status, national origin, ancestry, gender, sexual orientation, medical condition, or disability.
- Never harass, intimidate, threaten, or bully fellow members of the BCOC, the fire service, or the public, and report the actions of others who engage in such behavior.
- Comply with all applicable laws and campaign rules when supporting political candidates and engaging in political activities.
- Refrain from endorsing commercial products through quotations, photographs, testimonials, or similar means for personal gain.
- Use social networking, electronic communications, and other media technologies responsibly in a manner that does not discredit, dishonor, or embarrass the BCOC, and understand that failure to resolve or report inappropriate use of such media may be treated as condoning such behavior.

Board Members and Officers

All officers and Executive Board members of the BCOC shall always exercise the highest ethical standards of conduct and practice fundamental honesty.

Officers and Executive Board members shall not:

- Deceive, defraud, or mislead BCOC members, officers, or those with whom the BCOC has business or other relationships.
- Misrepresent the BCOC in any negotiation, dealing, contract, or agreement.
- Divulge or release information relating to the BCOC's plans, mission, or operational records without appropriate approval.
- Obtain a personal advantage or benefit through use of the organization's name.
- Accept individual gifts of any kind in excess of \$50.00 in connection with the individual's relationship with the BCOC.
- Withhold their best efforts in performing their duties to acceptable standards.
- Engage in unethical business practices of any kind.
- Use BCOC property, financial resources, or the services of BCOC members for personal benefit.
- Be convicted of any civil or criminal offense that materially undermines the integrity, credibility, or mission of the BCOC.

Infractions of this Statement of Personal and Professional Standards of Conduct shall be reported directly to any member of the Audit Committee, who may, in that member's judgment, refer the matter to the full Executive Board for review and action consistent with the bylaws and organizational policies of the BCOC.

ACKNOWLEDGE IN THE FEEDBACK FORM

Black Chief Officers' Committee · Prepared for feedback prior to the Executive Board vote and member vote in August 2026.